Instrument candidate log

This is the durable portfolio for proposed Field Lab instruments. It keeps promising operations, reserves, absorbed ideas, rejected ports, donor research, tests, and open questions in one place without making any candidate part of the canonical instrument bench.

The source research began in the Gentler inquiry modes Field Log. Candidates move into `reference/instruments/` only after a worked comparison shows distinct access, bounded artifacts, acceptable burden, and user value.

Portfolio snapshot

Candidate	Family	Status	Best next test
`design-grammar`	Transformation	**Promoted; trialed**	Evolve through ordinary use
`behavior-chain`	Transformation	**Promoted; draft**	One user-owned human action with enough recall to correct
`solution-analysis`	Transformation	**Promising; first test overfit**	Hard case plus a plain-solution baseline
`open-page`	Collection	**Promoted; draft**	One low-stakes run with no interruption or automatic analysis
`self-distanced-replay`	Transformation	**Promoted; draft**	Compare source, ordinary summary, and observer-view rendering
`formation-section`	Transformation	**Promoted; draft**	Versioned artifact with real overwrites and branches
`attribute-interpolation`	Transformation	**Promoted; draft**	One declared attribute with meaningful thresholds
`rubric-builder`	Transformation	**Promoted; draft**	A new domain with inspected contrasts and a true holdout
`evidenced-reassembly`	Transformation	**Parked**	Wait for a consequential fragmented-source case
`checked-score`	Transformation	Reserve	Process with simultaneous support, timing, and optionality
`nondetection-register`	Control / transformation	Reserve; likely absorb	Multi-detector blind-spot case
`free-language-profile`	Transformation	Reserve	Several specimens with distinct descriptive vocabularies
`detail-census`	Transformation	Reserve; overlap unresolved	Heterogeneous pile where `atlas` is an inadequate baseline

Status meanings

- **Promoted:** canonical card exists.
- **Strong:** mature donor and a plausible distinct access target; card still requires worked evidence.
- **Promising:** operation produced some useful signal but needs revision or a harder control.
- **First-tester candidate:** concrete and low enough burden to try, but its access claim remains untested.

- **Reserve:** preserve the idea and research; do not put it in the active queue.
- **Parked:** further refinement is not worth its cost until a natural use case appears.
- **Absorb:** useful control or kernel likely belongs in another card.
- **Withdrawn:** do not present it as a sourced port or active candidate.

Canonical cards also carry a separate home-domain maturity field: `draft` at zero documented completed runs, `trialed` at one to nine, `practiced` at ten to twenty-four, and `established` at twenty-five or more across at least five distinct inquiries. Donor evidence does not raise this status.

Evaluation rule

Before promoting a candidate, ask:

1. What distinct phenomenon does it reveal?
2. What remains unseen, entangled, or untested without it?
3. Does a plain answer or current instrument expose the same thing more cheaply?
4. What stable artifact can the user inspect and correct?
5. What structure does the operation inject?
6. What is its characteristic false positive or failure?
7. What are its emotional, exposure, attention, and choice loads?
8. Does a real user care about the access gain?

Donor-field maturity does not validate an LLM port. A candidate must survive a home-domain test.

Main candidate dossiers

Design Grammar (`design-grammar`)

- **Status:** Promoted on 2026-07-26; maturity `trialed`.
- **Family:** Transformation.
- **Donor:** Venkatesh Rao's account of oozification and the path from a specific artifact to a design grammar and then a language.
- **Operation:** Extract primitives, invariants, combination rules, precedence, costly cases, and adjacent forms from one fixed artifact or system.
- **Distinct from:** `structural-recombine`, which removes arrangements from several grounded domains and creates a new cross-domain structure.
- **Main artifacts:** Atomization can erase properties of the whole; generated examples can be mistaken for observed rules; apparent rules may hold only when cheap.
- **Current record:** Canonical card.
- **Disposition:** No candidate work is scheduled. Let real use expose needed changes.

Behavior Chain (`behavior-chain`)

- **Status:** Promoted on 2026-07-27; maturity `draft`.
- **Family:** Transformation.
- **Donor:** DBT behavioral chain analysis, kept recognizably distinct from invented Field Lab operations.

- **Input:** One bounded human action the user owns and wants to understand, with enough recall or records to trace one episode.
- **Operation:** Separate prior conditions and vulnerabilities, prompting event, reported environmental and internal links, target action, immediate and later consequences, missing evidence, and competing functional hypotheses.
- **Access target:** The corrected functional route by which one specific human action became possible or useful in its setting.
- **Difference from `substrate-map`:** Substrate Map gives the visible sequence. Behavior Chain adds precursor conditions, consequences, competing functions, and user-reported thoughts, feelings, body sensations, and environmental links.
- **Required controls:** Do not invent motives, emotions, or hidden experience. Keep testimony separate from causal hypotheses. Stop when recall is too sparse or the user does not want to revisit the material. Do not use it to shift responsibility onto a person subject to abuse, coercion, or another actor's target conduct.
- **Likely composition:** `open-page` or one-question collection → `behavior-chain` → user correction → `solution-analysis`.
- **Historical note:** One agent-failure comparison helped separate the candidate from `substrate-map`, but agent traces are not the target material for the shipped card and do not count toward its maturity.
- **Current record:** Canonical card.
- **Next useful case:** A human action with several plausible functions and enough user recall to correct the sequence.

Solution Analysis (`solution-analysis`)

- **Status:** Promising; first test was useful but overfit.
- **Family:** Transformation.
- **Donor:** DBT solution analysis.
- **Input:** A corrected behavior chain or an equivalent source-grounded functional sequence. Without that substrate it becomes generic brainstorming.
- **Operation:** Mark possible intervention sites, connect each proposed solution to a supported link, distinguish prevention, detection, recovery, and repair, test countercases, and select the cheapest adequate response.
- **Can run without Behavior Chain:** Yes, when another source already gives a grounded functional sequence. No, when the input is only a vague problem.
- **First test:** The Liang naming failure. It distinguished the upstream missing-name problem from the later false correction and produced prevention, detection, recovery, countercases, and a stop rule.
- **Observed weakness:** It overbuilt "event indexing plus a target-evidence check" around a simple adequate fix: always name the instrument and briefly say what it does. The secondary rule—reread the turn a user disputes—belongs in general interaction behavior.
- **Main artifact:** Elaborate safeguards can hide the cheapest sufficient change.
- **Test record:** Solution Analysis result.

- **Next useful case:** A problem with real tradeoffs, several intervention sites, and no obvious cheapest answer. Compare against an ordinary solution request.

Open Page (`open-page`)
- **Status:** Promoted on 2026-07-27; maturity `draft`.
- **Family:** Collection.
- **Donors:** Freewriting, open-page writing, uninterrupted response, and cognitive-interviewing controls.
- **Input:** One question or prompt and a user who would rather write or speak freely than answer repeated analytic questions.
- **Operation:** Give one bounded prompt; do not interrupt; do not automatically analyze; preserve the raw response; then ask one correction or extraction question.
- **Access target:** Material that becomes sayable when the user controls sequence, emphasis, and length.
- **Claim boundary:** This is an articulation method, not treatment. Expressive writing has mixed health evidence.
- **Main artifact:** It may merely produce more text. It earns a card only if the prompt, extraction, and correction reveal a distinct signal.
- **First-tester shape:** Use a low-stakes real question. Ask after the run: "Would you choose this way of working again for a similar question?"
- **Current record:** Canonical card.
- **Next useful case:** The user's wife is the intended first usability test.

Self-Distanced Replay (`self-distanced-replay`)
- **Status:** Promoted on 2026-07-27; maturity `draft`.
- **Family:** Transformation.
- **Donor:** Experimental work on self-distanced reflection.
- **Input:** A user-owned account of one event or tension.
- **Operation:** Preserve the source, then render an observer-view replay that separates visible action, reported inner state, interpretation, and missing information. The user corrects the rendering before any analysis.
- **Access target:** Narrative and emotional distance without denying the account or claiming an objective view.
- **Evidence:** Two meta-analytic research trails covered 25 experiments and 48 studies; effects appear modest and certainty is limited. The LLM rewrite is a new transfer, not the tested intervention.
- **Main artifacts:** The model can flatten feeling, sound falsely neutral, or turn distance into disbelief.
- **Current record:** Canonical card.
- **Next useful case:** Compare raw account, ordinary summary, and self-distanced replay on one non-crisis event; ask whether the replay reveals anything useful without alienating the user.

Formation Section (`formation-section`)
- **Status:** Promoted on 2026-07-27; maturity `draft`.

- **Family:** Transformation.
- **Donors:** Archaeological single-context recording, Harris matrices, stratigraphic interpretation, and formation-process analysis.
- **Input:** Versioned or accumulated material with real units, overwrites, branches, residual pieces, and incomplete order evidence.
- **Operation:** Preserve each unit; record direct earlier/later or overwrite relations; leave unrelated branches unordered; distinguish observed relation from inferred phase; keep the unit register beside the compressed account.
- **Access target:** How an artifact, belief, project, or dispute accumulated without forcing it into one timeline or smooth story.
- **Difference from `substrate-map`:** It models accumulated and versioned structure, not merely one event sequence.
- **Related ideas:** False-peak or hidden-work rendering mostly belongs here. It can expose maintenance and micro-work beneath a visible outcome.
- **Main artifacts:** Partial order becomes false duration; layers imply progress; later interpretations overwrite the units.
- **Current record:** Canonical card.
- **Next useful case:** A document or project with known versions, discarded branches, and later reuse.

Attribute Interpolation (`attribute-interpolation`)

- **Status:** Promoted on 2026-07-27; maturity `draft`.
- **Family:** Transformation.
- **Donors:** The user's "Flying Drones in Latent Space" essay, keyframe-like interpolation, controlled variation, and the useful part of the proposed Focal-Length Sweep.
- **Input:** One preserved specimen and one declared attribute worth varying.
- **Operation:** Generate controlled steps along that attribute while holding the source and other declared constraints stable; inspect thresholds, discontinuities, linked changes, and invariant features.
- **Access target:** Which qualities remain stable, which co-vary, and where the generated space changes character.
- **Main controls:** Outputs are generated probes, not measurements of a real continuous latent axis. Declare the varied attribute, anchors, held conditions, and induced changes.
- **Main artifacts:** False continuity, arbitrary scales, hidden correlated changes, and a perspective menu that recreates decision fatigue.
- **Current record:** Canonical card.
- **Next useful case:** A real writing, design, strategy, or concept specimen where the user already cares about a threshold along one attribute.

Rubric Builder (`rubric-builder`)

- **Status:** Promoted on 2026-07-27; maturity `draft`.
- **Family:** Transformation.

- **Donors:** Kyle Mathews's "Custom Rubrics for Agentic Search" essay, the Bakery and Restaurant Rubrics' calibration history, and criterion-referenced rubric design.
- **Input:** One bounded recurring judgment, positive and negative examples the person knows well enough to inspect, and at least one example withheld from criterion construction.
- **Operation:** Inspect each example deeply with the person, one question at a time, until small physical, structural, temporal, or behavioral details replace broad evaluative words. Preserve a corrected card for each example; compare the derivation examples; propose a small set of hidden but observable criteria; define evidence, anchors, unknowns, exceptions, and any necessary gates; audit easy proxies and suppressed good cases; then freeze and test the draft on the holdout before one traced revision.
- **Access target:** The observable distinctions and failure boundaries behind judgments the person can make more easily than explain.
- **Main controls:** Human correction of each example card, derivation/holdout separation, trace from criteria to inspected observations, `unknown` distinct from zero, positive evidence for exclusion, and a proxy-and-suppression audit.
- **Main artifacts:** Shallow intake disguised as elicitation, small-set overfit, training on the holdout, false precision, double-counted criteria, prominence or vocabulary as a proxy, and personal preference presented as a universal standard.
- **Workflow boundary:** The instrument designs and calibrates the rule. Popularity-neutral retrieval, scoring a candidate set, rendering a shortlist, lived feedback, and later revision are explicit workflow stages. Export creates a reusable copy of the tested rule; it is not a second instrument.
- **Current record:** Canonical card.
- **Next useful case:** A domain other than scratch food with three to five positive and negative examples plus one genuine holdout pair.

Evidenced Reassembly (`evidenced-reassembly`)

Current disposition

Parked. Do not add an instrument card yet.

The candidate has a clear donor practice, a bounded procedure, and a distinct failure mode. It does not yet have a strong enough demonstrated access gain. Three attempted trials had no valid specimen. A fourth, narrow trial recovered mostly source structure already visible to a close reader.

Resume this candidate when a concrete case contains fragments from one former whole and someone needs to recover their relations. Do not search for material merely to justify the instrument.

Short description

Evidenced Reassembly would reconstruct only those relations among fragments that direct source evidence supports. It would prefer physical or textual join evidence over thematic fit, grade every proposed join, expose every model-added bridge, preserve gaps and competing placements, and return instructions for taking the assembly apart.

Its intended result is not a fluent restored whole. It is the least-complete supported assembly.

Research lineage

Archaeological stratigraphy and the Refit Assay

A blind donor search first recruited archaeological stratigraphy: single-context recording, Harris matrices, refitting, and formation-process analysis. The home-blind study suggested two related transformations:

- **Formation Section:** recover earlier/later, overwrite, branch, phase, and residual relations from versioned or accumulated material.
- **Refit Assay:** seek direct joins among separated fragments; distinguish a join from shared vocabulary or theme; return reconstructed sets, missing pieces, and unresolved similarities.

The main warning was that archaeological language can make a textual inference sound more physical and certain than it is.

Source record: Gentler inquiry Field Log, archaeological studies.

Blind recruitment of transformation practices

A second home-blind search asked for mature operator-side methods that refashion existing heterogeneous material while preserving invariants, source trace, injected form, and loss. It recruited:

- Harris Matrix
- Labanotation
- Jeffersonian transcription
- anastylosis
- parameter-mapping sonification
- multiplanar reconstruction
- storyboarding
- verbatim theatre
- space-syntax axial mapping
- Barnes objective analysis

Anastylosis was selected for isolated research beside Labanotation and sonification. The anastylosis study was blind to the Field Lab but reused the blind recruiter, so it was not fresh to the donor slate.

Source record: Gentler inquiry Field Log, transformation recruitment.

Anastylosis

The architectural-conservation practice supplied the candidate's clearest kernel:

- Reassemble original dismembered parts only in evidenced positions.
- Keep additions minimal.
- Make additions recognizable.
- Preserve gaps when the evidence does not support completion.

- Record the intervention so later readers can distinguish original, placement, and supplement.

The home transfer was named **Evidenced Reassembly**. It strengthened the earlier Refit Assay by adding graded placements, visible supplements, an as-built trace, and dismantling.

Primary donor sources:

- The Venice Charter
- Acropolis Restoration Service intervention principles

Research record: Gentler inquiry Field Log, transformation studies.

Proposed phenomenon

Relations among fragments of one disrupted source that can be restored by direct evidence, as distinct from:

- grouping related material;
- reconstructing a topic or worldview;
- synthesizing several sources;
- repairing an intact but noisy transcript;
- supplying missing material; or
- creating a new structure from old parts.

Proposed specimen

The minimum specimen would contain:

1. two or more available, source-linked fragments;
2. evidence that they plausibly belonged to one former whole or longitudinal record;
3. relations that were disrupted, separated, overwritten, displaced, or made uncertain; and
4. surviving join evidence strong enough to test reconstruction without inventing it.

Useful join evidence might include:

- matching physical or textual edges;
- dates, sequence numbers, page numbers, or version IDs;
- reply headers, quotation chains, or continuation syntax;
- repeated identifiers;
- explicit cross-references;
- nesting or indentation;
- find location or order;
- edit history; and
- conflicting versions whose common ancestry is known.

The following do **not** establish a join by themselves:

- shared topic;
- shared author;
- shared style;
- shared vocabulary;

- membership in one folder, vault, inquiry, or company; or
- semantic compatibility.

Proposed operation

1. Freeze and label every fragment without rewriting it.
2. Record provenance, observed edges, repeated identifiers, cross-references, order clues, conflicts, and missing metadata.
3. Test fragment membership before placement.
4. Propose joins one at a time.
5. Grade each join `secure`, `probable`, `possible`, or `rejected`.
6. Assemble only secure and probable joins.
7. Keep possible placements outside the main assembly.
8. Add a model bridge only when needed for legibility. Mark it, minimize it, and state how to remove it.
9. Preserve every gap, displaced fragment, rejected join, and competing placement.
10. Return a trace from every reconstructed relation to its fragments and evidence.
11. Include a secure-only fallback and instructions for dismantling the assembly.

Proposed readout

- frozen fragment register;
- provenance and edge record;
- join-and-confidence table;
- least-complete supported assembly;
- visible supplement register;
- gap map;
- rejected joins;
- competing placements;
- as-built source trace;
- secure-only fallback; and
- dismantling instructions.

Main controls

- Direct join evidence outranks thematic or semantic fit.
- Paste order is unknown unless its source proves otherwise.
- A source-blind reader must be able to trace every relation to fragments and evidence.
- Removing model bridges must recover the preserved fragments.
- A nearby mixed-source case must fail the membership test.
- Missing fragments remain missing. The model must not write substitutes.
- A partial assembly is a valid stopping point.

Distinction from existing instruments

- **Substrate Map** records observable event order, handoffs, and missing observations. It does not restore a disrupted former arrangement.

- **Structural Recombination** deliberately makes a new cross-source structure. Evidenced Reassembly would seek the old arrangement and reject novel joins.
- **Design Grammar** extracts a reusable language. Evidenced Reassembly would reconstruct a particular source.
- **Formation Section** would model version, phase, overwrite, and branch relations. Evidenced Reassembly is narrower: fragment membership and direct joining evidence.
- **Refit Assay** is likely absorbed by this candidate if the candidate survives. Its direct-join test must not be lost.

If later trials show little access beyond source extraction plus a Substrate Map, absorb the useful controls into those instruments instead of creating a new card.

Possible composition

These are untested hypotheses:

- **After a collection instrument:** when the collection yields genuinely displaced pieces rather than observations about one topic.
- **Before Loss Audit:** to test whether the assembly omitted a supported fragment or relation.
- **Before Position Preservation:** only when fragments contain committed positions whose changes must remain visible.
- **With a fresh traceability reader:** to test whether the as-built account can be reconstructed from its cited evidence. The fresh reader must not invent new joins.

The operation would require high model effort but little user choice once a valid specimen exists. Ask for missing provenance one fact at a time.

Characteristic artifacts

- A fluent whole hides the gaps.
- Theme is mistaken for a join.
- Fragments from different systems or phases collapse into one account.
- Paste order becomes false chronology.
- The model supplies more text than the source.
- A minimal bridge quietly becomes a substantive claim.
- Confidence labels launder conjecture.
- “Probable” is read as “original.”
- The material metaphor gives textual relations false physical certainty.
- The register and grading work cost more than the recovered relation is worth.

Trial record

1. Liang Wenfeng / DeepSeek worldview — contraindicated

The task held an ordered but uncertain transcript, separate public acts, independent generated probes, comparison records, and one retrospective account of a conversation failure. None supplied available fragments with unresolved joins:

- translation uncertainty was not fragmentation;

- public acts did not once form one strategy document;
- generated probes were never one former whole; and
- the conversation episode was already reconstructed while most raw wording was missing.

Any run would have manufactured its specimen.

Result: Liang contraindication.

2. Volts transit research — contraindicated

The task held a complete transcript, separately authored country studies, explicit workflow artifacts, claim tests, and an append-only Field Log. Shared schema and provenance described a known research process; they did not show a disrupted former whole.

Result: Volts contraindication.

3. Tax-restructuring meeting — contraindicated

The source was one continuous transcript in preserved order. Bad speaker labels and transcription errors made attribution uncertain but did not displace the parts. Later analyses were derivative views with known lineage, not surviving fragments.

Result: Tax-meeting contraindication.

4. Pre-Electric journal excerpts — narrow and inconclusive

This was the first corpus that passed the suitability gate. It contained nine top-level pasted fragments, explicit nesting, quotations, relative-time phrases, an older embedded passage, and one sentence repeated at two list depths.

The trial identified:

- secure parent-child and quotation relations already visible in indentation;
- one secure older-within-newer relation marked "from ~3 years ago";
- one secure repeated-sentence relation with no supported direction;
- a probable local continuation from a finite/infinite-purpose note to "this all suggests" a life-script conclusion; and
- a probable callback from "as I was referencing above" to the preceding Gatsby, recognition, and anomie reflection.

It did **not** recover:

- dates;
- a global chronology;
- original entry boundaries;
- missing text;
- source direction for the repeated sentence; or
- one original note or document.

Most secure relations were already visible in the Markdown. The two probable joins relied on paste adjacency plus anaphora and were available to ordinary close reading. The operation produced a more explicit and reversible audit, but it did not show a large enough access gain to warrant a card.

Results:

- Admission comparison
- Frozen specimen

Field Log screening

Eight Field Logs under `/Users/kylemathews/programs/dialectics` were screened. The July book-club material was a complete timestamped session summary; Quicksilver excerpts retained their page-local provenance; the Databricks/Yan transcript was complete but garbled; and the remaining logs contained related sources or generated artifacts rather than displaced pieces. No further natural positive case was found.

What the trials taught us

The admission gate is useful

Three failed runs sharply separated fragmentation from:

- uncertainty;
- incompleteness;
- noisy transcription;
- related documents;
- analytical lineage; and
- a collection assembled after the fact.

That gate may be worth preserving even if the full candidate never becomes an instrument.

A traceable result is not necessarily a useful result

The journal trial showed that join grades, removable bridges, and dismantling can make an interpretation auditable. It did not show that the interpretation was hard to reach or important enough to justify the machinery.

Negative calibration dominated positive access

The strongest observed value so far is refusing false reconstruction. That is a real control, but it may belong in source-handling rules or another instrument rather than in a standalone transformation.

The candidate may be too specimen-dependent

Field Logs and normal AI chats tend to preserve too much order or contain several related sources rather than fragments of one damaged source. Natural use cases may occur more often in archives, version recovery, email exports, messaging fragments, or document forensics than in ordinary Field Lab work.

Hypothetical use cases worth watching for

Do not treat these as validation:

- parts of one email or message thread with reply headers and quoted text but missing order;
- sections of one draft recovered from backups, conflict files, or divergent versions;
- notes from one event scattered across tools while retaining timestamps, IDs, and cross-references;
- excerpts from one manuscript with page numbers, continuation syntax, and duplicated passages;
- incident fragments known to come from one episode and carrying request IDs, sequence numbers, or causal handoffs; and
- archival fragments with catalogued find positions and matching physical or textual edges.

The first good use case should matter without the instrument: someone should already need to know which pieces belong together, what order is supported, or where the gaps are.

Resume conditions

Reopen research only when all of these hold:

1. A concrete user need exists before instrument selection.
2. The corpus has genuine fragments from one former whole or known longitudinal record.
3. Original relations are materially uncertain.
4. Several hard join clues survive.
5. An unaided close reading or Substrate Map leaves a consequential relation unresolved.
6. Recovering that relation would change understanding, explanation, or action.

Then run:

1. the suitability gate;
2. a frozen plain summary;
3. a canonical Substrate Map;
4. Evidenced Reassembly; and
5. a comparison of access gain, unsupported structure, traceability, burden, and user value.

Promote the candidate only if it repeatedly reveals consequential supported relations that the baselines miss. Otherwise preserve its controls and absorb them into an existing instrument.

Open questions

- Is restoration of prior relation common enough in Field Lab material to deserve a card?
- Does the useful kernel belong inside Formation Section, Substrate Map, or general provenance rules?
- Can the result remain readable without hiding join grades and gaps?
- What level of user confirmation should a probable join require?
- Is "dismantling" useful to users or mainly an audit device for models?
- Can a fresh traceability reader test an assembly without silently adding new joins?
- What concrete case would produce a decision or understanding that a close reader could not reach with much less machinery?

Decision log

- **2026-07-26:** Refit Assay proposed from archaeological stratigraphy.
- **2026-07-26:** Anastylosis donor study strengthened it into Evidenced Reassembly.
- **2026-07-26:** Candidate planned; card deferred pending a worked comparison.
- **2026-07-27:** Liang, Volts, and tax-meeting corpora rejected at suitability.
- **2026-07-27:** Journal corpus produced a narrow partial assembly.
- **2026-07-27:** Initial trial verdict said "admit," then review found that the claimed access gain was too small. Candidate reclassified as **parked**.
- **2026-07-27:** Further refinement deferred until a concrete use case appears.

Reserve candidate dossiers

Checked Score (`checked-score`)

- **Status:** Reserve.
- **Family:** Transformation.
- **Donor:** Labanotation and the movement-check principle.
- **Operation:** Refashion an event or process into simultaneous layers such as action, support, timing, contact, handoff, and optionality. Ask a separate reader to reconstruct the process from the score.
- **Access target:** Relations that disappear when a concurrent process becomes a simple narrative sequence.
- **Control:** Keep the score versioned and incomplete; state what it preserves and omits; use a reconstruction check rather than trusting notation density.
- **Main artifacts:** False precision, frozen contingency, and the implication that a score preserves body, style, or every transition.
- **Reason held in reserve:** It needs a real non-movement specimen that reveals more than `substrate-map`.

Nondetection Register (`nondetection-register`)

- **Status:** Reserve; likely a control to absorb.
- **Family:** Control or transformation.
- **Donor:** Ecological occupancy and imperfect-detection methods.
- **Operation:** Run one named signal through genuinely different detectors and record `detected`, `not detected`, `missing`, and `uncertain` for each.
- **Access target:** Method-specific blind spots and the difference between absence and nondetection.
- **Control:** Do not transfer occupancy probabilities without a real sampling design. Track detector dependence, shared observer error, false positives, closure, and missing coverage.
- **Main artifacts:** Recurrence becomes fake probability; correlated prompts look independent; absence is declared from one miss.
- **Likely home:** Improve `blind-cartography` and `framing-sensitivity` before creating a standalone card.

Free-Language Profile (`free-language-profile`)

- **Status:** Reserve.
- **Family:** Transformation.
- **Donor:** Sensory free-choice profiling.
- **Operation:** Derive descriptive qualities separately from several supplied specimens, align only defensible synonyms, and preserve each specimen's lexicon and unexplained residual differences.
- **Access target:** Similarities and differences that a shared vocabulary would erase.
- **Control:** Preserve raw descriptions before alignment. Separate similarity from preference and do not treat consensus language as shared perception.
- **Main artifacts:** False synonymy, forced consensus, heavy rating load, and invented geometry.
- **Reason held in reserve:** It needs several comparable specimens and a user who values the preserved language enough to justify the burden.

Detail Census (`detail-census`)

- **Status:** Reserve; overlap unresolved.
- **Family:** Transformation.
- **Donor:** Rao's "Oozy Intelligence in Slow Time" and the model's cheap patience for tedious detail.
- **Operation:** Turn a heterogeneous pile into source-linked units, normalized fields, duplicates, contradictions, unknowns, and a compact summary with drill-down.
- **Access target:** Fine structure below the human patience threshold.
- **Control:** Keep exhaustive work backstage; mark missing coverage and inferred fields; do not claim completeness from fluency.
- **Main artifacts:** False completeness, invented detail, premature atomization, and the loss of properties that belong to wholes.
- **Reason held in reserve:** It may be an `atlas` mode, a research utility, or a workflow rather than a distinct instrument.

Preliminary collection pool

These ideas help users express material. Most received only donor-level research. They are not in the active card queue.

Critical Incident (`critical-incident`)

- **Donor maturity:** Flanagan's Critical Incident Technique has a long operational history.
- **Possible operation:** Ask for one concrete incident, then recover setting, action, effect, criteria for success or failure, and missing facts.
- **Why it may help:** Low choice load and a bounded specimen.
- **Overlap risk:** It may be a collection preface to `substrate-map` or `behavior-chain`, not a separate access target.

Rich Picture (`rich-picture`)

- **Possible operation:** Let the user draw or verbally construct the whole situation without a supplied formal model; preserve relations, symbols, tensions, and omissions for correction.

- **Why it may help:** Visual and relational expression before analysis.
- **Main artifact:** The model may decode symbols as hidden truth or formalize the picture too soon.
- **Evidence limit:** Strong practice history and case use; limited comparative evidence.

One-Object Story (`one-object-story`)

- **Possible operation:** Choose or recall one object, image, place, or song that belongs with the issue and explain the relation.
- **Why it may help:** Concrete, low-choice entry into affective or relational material.
- **Main artifact:** Treating the object as a projective test rather than a user-owned prompt.

Third-Person Story Completion (`third-person-story-completion`)

- **Possible operation:** Continue a fictional scene that shares the issue's structure; keep the result explicitly fictional.
- **Why it may help:** Indirect articulation with lower self-exposure.
- **Main artifact:** Claiming the story reveals the user's hidden motives or likely conduct.

Participant Timeline (`participant-timeline`)

- **Possible operation:** Let the user draw or describe events with loops, gaps, parallel tracks, pauses, and turning points.
- **Why it may help:** User-owned sequence instead of a model-imposed linear history.
- **Main artifact:** Spatial layout becomes false duration or causality.

Go-Along (`go-along`)

- **Possible operation:** The user walks through a relevant place or routine and reports what becomes noticeable there.
- **Why it may help:** Situated cues unavailable to retrospective talk.
- **Main artifact:** High time and world-access burden; the method may be a collection protocol rather than an LLM instrument.

Live Task Narration (`live-task-narration`)

- **Possible operation:** Perform a real task while reporting only what is already passing through awareness.
- **Why it may help:** Tacit sequence, exceptions, and tool interactions.
- **Main artifact:** Narration changes performance and misses inaccessible cognition. Do not infer hidden process from silence.

Soundtrack or Sound Map (`sound-map`)

- **Possible operation:** Arrange sounds or songs around parts of a situation, then let the user explain the relations.
- **Why it may help:** Non-propositional association and temporal form.
- **Main artifact:** Copyright, tool access, and the model overreading taste.

Collage or Constellation (`constellation`)

- **Possible operation:** Arrange supplied fragments spatially before naming categories.

- **Why it may help:** Proximity, isolation, cluster, and salience can precede explanation.
- **Main artifact:** Two-dimensional placement manufactures geometry or forces crisp clusters.

Speculative Artifact (`speculative-artifact`)

- **Possible operation:** Create a letter, review, object description, or news item from one possible future.
- **Why it may help:** Makes implications and desired qualities concrete.
- **Main artifact:** Vividness becomes prediction or recommendation.

Ambivalence Reflection (`ambivalence-reflection`)

- **Donor:** Autonomy-preserving double-sided reflection from motivational interviewing and related counseling practice.
- **Possible operation:** Return both sides of the user's expressed ambivalence in their language without ranking or closing it.
- **Why it may help:** Recognition before change or decision.
- **Main artifact:** Manufactured symmetry, subtle steering, or repetition without access gain.

Exception Tracing (`exception-tracing`)

- **Donor:** Solution-focused exception questions.
- **Possible operation:** Find concrete occasions when the expected pattern did not occur; preserve the conditions and limits of the exception.
- **Why it may help:** Variation becomes visible without demanding a global explanation.
- **Main artifact:** Treating a rare exception as a ready solution or blaming the user for not reproducing it.

Values-Direction Writing (`values-direction-writing`)

- **Possible operation:** Invite unranked writing about directions worth moving toward without forcing a choice, score, or permanent identity.
- **Why it may help:** Values can appear before decision criteria.
- **Main artifact:** The prompt turns temporary language into a stable value hierarchy or moral demand.

Preliminary transformation pool

Three-Register Recast (`three-register-recast`)

- **Possible operation:** Render the same material as felt experience, reasoned account, and an attempted integration.
- **Main artifact:** Feeling becomes "irrational," while the model's synthesis receives the authority of "wise mind."
- **Status:** Prototype idea only.

Cope-Ahead Scene (`cope-ahead-scene`)

- **Possible operation:** Turn a settled plan into a future scene containing an obstacle, response, recovery, and next step.
- **Best use:** Late, after the user has chosen a plan.

- **Main artifact:** Premature planning, simulated certainty, or overlap with `real-world-check`.
- **Status:** Prototype idea only.

Parameter-Mapping Sonification (`sonification`)

- **Donor:** Auditory display and parameter-mapping sonification.
- **Possible operation:** Disclose a repeatable mapping from source data and transforms to sound parameters, with anchors and null cases.
- **Access target:** Temporal patterns or anomalies that another modality makes easier to notice.
- **Main artifacts:** Scan order, smoothing, scale, loudness, and musicality manufacture salience.
- **Status:** Tool-gated research lead, not a core text-only card. Its mapping manifest and false-salience controls may transfer elsewhere.

Absorbed, split, or redirected ideas

Refit Assay

- **Disposition:** Absorbed into Evidenced Reassembly.
- **Kernel to preserve:** Direct joins outrank resemblance; return missing pieces and unresolved similarities.

Focal-Length Sweep

- **Disposition:** Split rather than kept as one broad card.
- **Surviving candidate:** `attribute-interpolation`.
- **Other operations:** Constituent zoom, depth-of-field changes, and cross-cultural traversal may belong in existing camera or frame instruments.

Generative-Grammar Extraction

- **Disposition:** Promoted in refined form as `design-grammar`.
- **Boundary:** One fixed system becomes primitives, invariants, rules, and adjacent forms; multi-source Boydian decomposition remains `structural-recombine`.

False-Peak / Hidden-Work Rendering

- **Disposition:** Likely part of `formation-section`.
- **Kernel:** Expose accumulated maintenance and micro-work behind a visible outcome.

Nondetection Controls

- **Disposition:** Likely improvements to `blind-cartography` and `framing-sensitivity`.
- **Kernel:** A missed signal is not an absent signal; detectors may share blind spots and errors.

Withdrawn DBT attributions

The following names were invented Field Lab mappings, not verified DBT practices. Do not present them as DBT ports.

Transaction Loop

- **Idea:** Render reciprocal action, effect, response, environment, and power.

- **Why withdrawn:** It is not a standard named DBT practice. The transactional view is real; this procedure was invented.
- **Independent research possibility:** Systems, conversation analysis, and interactional sociology may support a future operation. False symmetry and victim-blaming are the main risks.

Clean Ask

- **Idea:** Turn relational material into a concise request or boundary that preserves objective, relationship, and self-respect concerns.
- **Why withdrawn:** Inspired by DBT interpersonal-effectiveness work but not a verified DBT instrument under this name and procedure.
- **Independent research possibility:** Communication design, mediation, or rhetoric. Main risks are manipulation, confidence, and unsafe use.

Dialectical Recast

- **Idea:** Turn extreme or binary formulations into source-traced scoped both/and alternatives while preserving real incompatibility.
- **Why withdrawn:** The dialectical skill is real, but this model-side transformation was invented.
- **Independent research possibility:** May overlap `tension-statement`, `third-pole`, and `position-preservation`. False balance is the main risk.

Researched practices not in the card queue

DBT practices

- **Check the Facts:** Real DBT skill; much of its portable work overlaps observation/inference separation and `real-world-check`. It can invalidate sound threat perception if used without validation.
- **Dialectics / Walking the Middle Path:** Real DBT practice; much of its portable work overlaps `tension-statement`, `third-pole`, and the full dialectic. It can create false equivalence.
- **Mindfulness What/How skills:** Real DBT practices; their strongest transfer is global interaction behavior—observe, describe, one thing at a time—rather than another card.
- **Problem Solving:** Real DBT practice; generic form overlaps ordinary planning, while link-specific repair belongs in `solution-analysis`.
- **Radical Acceptance, Turning the Mind, and Willingness:** Real DBT practices, but the Field Lab is not treating distress. Acceptance language can demand resignation to danger or injustice.
- **Opposite Action:** Real DBT practice with exposure-like features and high misuse risk when emotion fits the facts. Not a current Field Lab port.
- **STOP:** Real DBT crisis-interruption skill. It is an interaction or self-regulation tool, not a Field Lab transformation.

Cognitive interviewing

- **Disposition:** Global interview rules, not a card.
- **Transferred kernels:** One question at a time; let an answer finish; test what a question meant to the user; use paraphrase and targeted probes; delay interpretation.

DBT-informed interaction rules

- **Disposition:** Implemented globally.
- **Transferred kernels:** Attend ⟶ reflect ⟶ ask; validation before change; observe and describe before interpreting; nonjudgmental behavioral language; one recommended path rather than a large menu; no therapist role or clinical authority.

Cognitive-function inquiry modes

- **Disposition:** Routing vocabulary, not eight cards.
- **Kernel:** Let the live case suggest a concrete/symbolic, convergent/divergent, logical/relational, or internal/external mode. A stated MBTI type may be a hint but does not assign ability or govern the route.
- **Open gap:** No eight-way candidate palette completed card admission. Do not invent one from the labels alone.

Steady Schlepp

- **Disposition:** Workflow pattern, not an instrument.
- **Pattern:** Compose bounded inventory, normalization, linking, checking, and compression passes while keeping exhaustive model work backstage.

Instrument composition metadata

- **Disposition:** Card-schema improvement, not an instrument.
- **Idea:** Directional `after`, `parallel`, `before`, and `control` hints that help Kit propose workflows without authorizing automatic execution.

Linked Map

- **Disposition:** Renderer or presentation utility, not an instrument.

Source index

DBT and therapy-derived practices

- Oxford Handbook of DBT: chain and solution analysis
- Behavioral Tech: strengthening chain and solution analysis
- Linehan official DBT teaching materials
- Self-distancing meta-analysis, 25 experiments
- Self-distancing review, 48 studies
- Expressive-writing meta-analysis

Interviewing and incident collection

- U.S. Census cognitive-interviewing standard
- CDC cognitive interviewing
- APA Critical Incident Technique bibliography
- Open Rich Pictures guide

Archaeology, ecology, and sensory science

- Historic England archaeological recording manual

- Original occupancy-model paper
- Occupancy-method review
- Original free-choice profiling study
- Projective-mapping review

Transformation research

- Oozy Intelligence in Slow Time
- Fear of Oozification
- Flying Drones in Latent Space
- Custom Rubrics for Agentic Search
- International Council of Kinetography Laban
- Dance Notation Bureau fundamentals
- Hermann's sonification taxonomy
- Parameter-mapping sonification review
- The Venice Charter
- Acropolis Restoration Service intervention principles

Portfolio decision log

- **2026-07-26:** Interaction changes, donor research, and candidate hunt began.
- **2026-07-26:** Behavior Chain and Solution Analysis retained as verified DBT practices; invented DBT-sounding ports withdrawn.
- **2026-07-26:** Archaeology, ecology, and sensory science produced Formation Section, Refit Assay, Nondetection Register, and Free-Language Profile.
- **2026-07-26:** Rao research produced Detail Census, Focal-Length Sweep, and Generative-Grammar Extraction; later comparison split or refined them.
- **2026-07-26:** `design-grammar` promoted to the canonical bench.
- **2026-07-26:** Transformation study produced Checked Score, sonification controls, and Evidenced Reassembly.
- **2026-07-27:** An agent-failure comparison informed Behavior Chain's admission test, but the shipped card was narrowed to human material and the comparison was excluded from its maturity count.
- **2026-07-27:** Solution Analysis produced useful repairs but overfit a simple case.
- **2026-07-27:** Evidenced Reassembly failed three suitability gates, produced only a weak gain on a fourth corpus, and was parked.
- **2026-07-27:** Portfolio consolidated into this log for user evaluation.
- **2026-07-27:** Behavior Chain, Open Page, Self-Distanced Replay, Formation Section, and Attribute Interpolation were promoted to the canonical bench as human-facing drafts.
- **2026-07-27:** Canonical cards gained audited home-domain maturity and completed-use fields with higher thresholds for practiced and established status.
- **2026-07-27:** `rubric-builder` was promoted as a draft. Its core operation is deep, human-guided inspection of examples before criterion extraction; it keeps retrieval, application, export, and repeated revision outside the instrument.